

CEO Playbook — Justine, Omnix

Written 2026-07-01. This is your operating manual as CEO of Omnix. Not a business plan. A daily-use reference for the decisions, mindset, and machinery you'll run in the next 90 days.

Everything in this document assumes: **the product works, the payment path works, the auto-updater works, and the first sale is the only thing between you and cash flow.**

Part 1 — The CEO mindset

Before the machinery, the psychology. If you don't inhabit this frame of mind, no playbook works. Read this section first. Re-read it Monday mornings when the doubt creeps in.

Your role — one sentence

Talk to shop owners. Fix what breaks their day. Nothing else.

Everything you do collapses into one of those two. If a task doesn't, delegate it, defer it, or drop it. This is the entire job.

The frame

You are not a developer who happens to run a company. You are the founder of the software company that will run POS for a thousand Kenyan SMEs in three years. That is not an aspiration. That is the reality you have already decided to walk into. The code has been written. The compliance is real. The M-Pesa flow works. Everything from here is you making it real by talking to people.

The frame is not "I hope this works." The frame is "**this is already working, I just need to catch up to it.**" You are not the seller of a possibility. You are the operator of an existing thing. Every conversation is you making a customer aware of what already exists.

Ruthlessness — what it actually means

Ruthless is not cruel. Ruthless means **you don't let anything that isn't the mission survive on your calendar.** A ruthless CEO looks like this:

- **Says no to 90% of requests.** People ask you to attend events, join panels, sit on committees, coffee catch-ups. Most of these are not customer conversations. Say no politely and move on. "Thanks — not this quarter, I'm heads-down on customer growth. Ask me again in October."
- **Fires his own habits when they stop working.** If your morning routine isn't producing sales after 10 days, change it that Sunday. Not next month. Next Sunday.
- **Ends conversations that aren't going anywhere.** A shop owner who's "still deciding" after three follow-ups isn't buying. Say "It sounds like now isn't the right time. I'll check in with you in 60 days — good luck." Move on. Your time is worth the next call, not this one.
- **Cuts features that aren't paying rent.** If a module you built isn't selling in 60 days, don't polish it — go find why nobody wants it. Interview 5 potential buyers. If the answer is "we're too different from your assumption," pivot the module or park it.
- **Charges what the product is worth even when it hurts.** KES 30,000 is your price. When someone says "too expensive," you don't discount to KES 20,000 out of nervousness. You explain the ROI in the first 30 days and ask them what they'd save in receipts / eTIMS penalties / staff time. Then you let them decide. Some walk away. That's fine — they were never your customer.

Ruthlessness is a discipline of subtraction. Everything you say yes to is a no to something else. Say yes only to what moves you closer to 100 paying customers.

Fearlessness — what it actually is

Fearlessness is not the absence of fear. It is **the practice of moving before the fear finishes forming**.

You will be afraid every day for the next 90 days. Afraid of rejection. Afraid of your bank balance. Afraid of the shop owner saying "no." Afraid the product breaks on their PC. Afraid your competitor wins. These fears are correct — they mean you're doing something risky. That's the job.

What separates a CEO from an aspiring one is the **speed at which they act despite fear**. Here's the pattern:

- Fear arises !' don't argue with it !' don't wait for it to dissolve !' take the smallest concrete action toward the thing !' the fear shrinks as you move.

Concrete examples:

- **Afraid to send the first cold WhatsApp?** Send it before you re-read it a third time. Rewrite doesn't help; sending does.
- **Afraid your demo will bomb?** Do it anyway. Bomb the first three. Get better on the fourth.
- **Afraid a rich pharmacist will laugh at your pricing?** Quote it flat, with confidence, and don't apologize. If he laughs, thank him for his time and walk out. His laughter costs you nothing; the next chemist you visit doesn't know he laughed.
- **Afraid to charge someone who can barely afford it?** Charge them. If they buy, they'll value it. If they don't, they weren't buying anyway. Poverty is not a sales objection to solve — it's a customer segment to exclude.

The moment you notice fear, take the next step within 30 seconds. Don't process it. Don't journal it. Move. The fear is a tax on hesitation; movement pays it down.

Clarity — see through the noise

A CEO is paid to see clearly when everyone else can't. Your specific superpower: you've built the product yourself, so you have unfiltered access to how it actually works. Use that.

Concrete practices for clarity:

- **When a customer describes a problem, don't nod politely.** Ask "walk me through exactly what you did" — twice if needed. Most feature requests come from a misunderstanding that a 60-second explanation would clear up. Save that feature for a real gap.
- **When two things compete for your attention, ask "which one earns money by Friday?"** That's the answer. Not the more interesting one. Not the intellectually satisfying one. The one that puts KES on the till.
- **When you're stuck, describe the problem out loud to a wall.** If you can't say it in two sentences, you don't understand it yet. Don't move until you can.
- **When you're winning, say what specifically caused it.** "3 sales this week because we offered free install" is a data point. "Things are going well" is a feeling. CEO thinks in data points.
- **When you're losing, name the specific failure.** "Zero sales this week because I sent 20 messages but didn't follow up." Not "the market is hard right now." The former is fixable; the latter is a story you tell to feel less bad.

The 60-second decision rule

A CEO makes 40 decisions a day. If each takes 5 minutes, that's 3.5 hours of decision-making. You don't have 3.5 hours. Most decisions are reversible; make them fast, revisit if wrong.

The 60-second rule: give any decision that isn't life-changing exactly 60 seconds of thought. Then commit. Then move.

Examples of decisions that should take under 60 seconds:

- Should I follow up with this lead today or tomorrow? (Today)
- Should I say yes to this feature request? (Usually no — see the framework in Part 3)
- Should I discount to close this sale? (No — hold the price)
- Should I attend this event? (Only if 5+ potential customers will be there)
- Should I hire a part-time installer? (Only after 20 paying customers)

Examples that deserve real thought (2-3 days max):

- Should we open a second module vertical? (Wait for demand signal first)
- Should I sign this reseller partnership contract? (Check terms carefully)
- Should we raise our price? (Look at conversion math)
- Should I let this customer refund + refuse a subsequent sale? (Yes if they were toxic; no otherwise)

The bias toward action: when in doubt, act. A wrong action produces information (customer says no !' learn why). Inaction produces nothing.

Saying no with confidence

You will say no more times in the next 90 days than in your entire life prior. Practice the language now:

- **To a lead who ghosts and returns 3 weeks later** with "I have questions": "Happy to talk — I have 15 minutes at 2pm on Thursday. Do you want to book that slot or are you at a stage where you're ready to install?" Force a commitment.
- **To a customer asking for a feature you won't build:** "That's a great idea — I'm going to keep it on my priority list. In the meantime, here's a workaround that gets you 80% of what you need."
- **To a well-meaning friend who wants to introduce you to "someone in tech":** "Actually, right now the introductions that help me are with pharmacy owners or hardware store owners. Anyone in your network run one of those?"
- **To a "we can co-market" partnership pitch from another SaaS startup:** "Not this quarter — I'm heads-down on direct customer sales. Let's reconnect in Q4."
- **To your own doubts:** "That thought is a feeling, not a fact. What's the next concrete action?" and move.

Saying no isn't rude. Saying no is respect — you take the other person seriously enough to be honest, and you take yourself seriously enough to protect your time.

The lonely part

Founder solitude is real. Some days you'll do 8 hours of outreach and close nothing. You'll wonder if you made the right call not taking that engineer job.

The lonely part is a feature, not a bug. Here's how to survive it:

- **One trusted peer, not five.** Have exactly one other founder in your life you can text at 10pm and say "today was rough." Not a public support group. One person. Reciprocate.
- **Log wins in writing.** Weekly. A one-line note like "closed Sokoro Chemist Thursday — my first paid customer." Read them back on bad days. Your brain will forget wins faster than losses; the log reminds it.
- **Exercise 3× a week, non-negotiable.** Sales is a physical job. Your energy is capital. Depleted body =

depleted pitch. 30 minutes running, walking, or gym — every second day at minimum.

- **Don't drink to celebrate.** Not because alcohol is bad. Because you'll want to celebrate a small win with 3 beers and lose Monday morning. Celebrate with a good meal, a rest day, or a call to your mother. Save alcohol for milestones — first 10 customers, first 50, first 100. Big enough events that a lost Monday still nets positive.

- **Have a Sunday ritual.** Same thing every Sunday. Church, a hike, cooking, whatever. It's the thing that reminds you life exists outside sales. Non-negotiable. Miss it and you become brittle by Wednesday.

The founder identity shift

The hardest change is internal. You have to move from "software engineer who is trying to sell" to "founder who happens to write code."

Signals you've made the shift:

- You describe yourself as "founder of Omnix" before "software engineer"
- Someone asks what you're working on, you say a customer name (not a feature name)
- Your first thought at 6am is a customer conversation, not a bug
- You feel MORE alive doing a demo than closing a Git PR
- You would rather ship an install than ship a code refactor

The shift is real. It takes ~30-60 days of doing the work. If after 60 days you still feel like you're impersonating a CEO, that's data — either double down on the sales activities (usually the fix) or seriously consider that you might be an engineer who prefers being one (also fine, just clarifies the path).

Handling rejection specifically

You will hear "no" 20+ times before your first "yes." Real numbers, not exaggeration.

The reframe: **each "no" is a data point, not a verdict.** Every rejection either:

1. Tells you the target segment is wrong !' adjust who you approach
2. Tells you the pitch is wrong !' adjust the opener
3. Tells you the price is wrong !' almost never; hold the line
4. Tells you the person isn't a decision-maker !' find who is
5. Tells you nothing !' they weren't going to buy; move on

Never take a "no" personally. If a pharmacy owner says "no thanks, I use paper," they're not saying you're bad at your job. They're saying they don't feel the pain enough to change. Your job is to find the pharmacy owner who DOES feel it — and there are ~10,000 in Kenya, so keep dialing.

The 20-message rule: never let yourself despair before you've sent 20 more messages. Despair is calibrated against effort. If you've sent 5 messages and want to give up, send 15 more first. If you've sent 200, then despair is a data point worth listening to.

Daily affirmations that are actually true

Not fluff. Statements you can defend with evidence:

1. **"I built something that works."** True — auto-updater, licensing, M-Pesa, KRA eTIMS, four verticals, all shipping. You can pull up the codebase and prove it.
2. **"My price is fair."** True — one-time KES 30k vs competitors' KES 40-60k/year. Do the math over 3 years.
3. **"Every conversation is a decision to grow, not to survive."** True — the product is done. You're not

proving it works. You're finding who wants it.

4. **"I don't need permission to be a CEO. I already am one."** True — the moment you incorporate + sell one thing, you are. Everything else is momentum.

5. **"The next customer is closer than I think."** True — probably 5-15 conversations away. Statistically demonstrable.

Repeat these when you're driving between demos. Not out loud like a caricature. Just as background thoughts. They become facts by repetition.

Part 2 — The commercial machine

Now the mechanics. Assumes you've made the mental shift above.

The three modes of your workday

You'll oscillate between these all day. Learn to switch fast; don't linger.

Sales mode (60% of your time)

- On the phone
- WhatsApp voice notes
- In a matatu to a pharmacy
- Doing installs
- Recording testimonials

Look like: shoes on, laptop in a bag, phone in hand, thermal printer as needed.

Sound like: "Habari. I'm Justine, I built pharmacy software for Kenyan shops. Can I stop by tomorrow between 10 and 12?"

Support mode (25% of your time)

- Reading messages from installed customers
- Debugging their specific issue
- Doing quick fixes on their PC or over TeamViewer
- Making the next release fix that thing

Look like: at your laptop, but with a WhatsApp thread open on the side.

Sound like: "That's a good catch — I'll fix it today. In the meantime, do X."

Build mode (15% of your time)

- Actual coding, only for issues that came from Support mode
- Never speculative features
- Never "polish"
- Time-boxed to 4-hour blocks max

Rule: if your build mode isn't triggered by a specific customer conversation, close the editor. That week's work is Sales or Support instead.

Your daily rhythm — first 90 days

Weekday mornings (06:00 – 09:00)

06:00 — wake, coffee, review. No email yet.

06:15 — read yesterday's WhatsApp threads. For each: reply (Sales), triage (Support), or note for later (Pipeline).

06:30 — prep today's outreach. Atlas Prospector: new leads for today's target. Draft 3 opener variations if needed.

07:00 — Support triage. Any customer issue from overnight? Log it, decide fix-today vs fix-this-week.

08:00 — send Monday's 20 voice notes (or today's outreach batch). Do it before your energy fades.

Weekday middays (09:00 – 15:00)

- Demo days: at pharmacies, installing, closing sales. Take payment on the spot.
- Non-demo days: inbound WhatsApp (Sales), Support tickets, then 90-min build block if needed.

Lunch at 12:30, always. Skipping lunch = grumpy afternoon = bad sales conversations.

Weekday afternoons (15:00 – 18:00)

- Follow-ups: leads that haven't converted, quick check-ins with recent customers
- Reseller check-in (once you have one): 15-min video call, "any leads warming up?"

Weekday evenings (18:00 – 21:00)

- Build mode if needed (max 90 min — you're tired)
- Documentation: log what worked / didn't in a plain-text file
- Next-day prep by 21:00

Weekends

- **Saturday morning**: post yesterday's install photos on WhatsApp Status + X + Facebook groups
- **Saturday afternoon**: cold outreach to weekend-trading shops
- **Sunday**: rest. Non-negotiable. Burned-out CEO !' grumpy calls !' no sales.

The pricing (locked, don't change without owner review)

Line item	Launch (first 10)	Standard	Renewal (year 2+)
Dawa module	KES 15,000	KES 30,000	KES 12,000/year maintenance
Retail module	KES 15,000	KES 30,000	KES 12,000/year maintenance
Hospitality module	KES 15,000	KES 30,000	KES 12,000/year maintenance
Hardware module	KES 15,000	KES 30,000	KES 12,000/year maintenance

Why:

- KES 30k is under the "I need to consult my accountant" threshold — owners can decide in the moment
- KES 15k launch creates real urgency (you can only install ~10/

module/month solo)

- KES 12k/year

renewal is your ARR.

100 customers × 12k =

KES 1.2M recurring

after year 1.

Never discount below KES 15k in launch window. If they can't afford it, put them on trial and revisit in 30 days. **Never** offer monthly. That's Loyverse's game, don't play it.

Payment methods

Preferred: Paystack link !' M-Pesa STK !' license auto-activates in 30 seconds.

Backup: M-Pesa Till !' customer pays !' sends you code !' you enter it in /admin/licenses/[id]/mark-paid !' activates.

Never: cheque, bank transfer, "I'll bring cash next week." Cash flow risk. Paystack + M-Pesa covers 99%.

The reseller ladder

Volume	Commission	Notes
1-10 installs	20%	Starting tier
11-30 installs	25%	Reward for repeat
31+ installs	30%	Distributor-level

Sign as reseller: pharmacy distributor reps, small-business IT consultants, retail supplier reps (Coca-Cola / Bidco routes), cousins with 100+ business contacts.

Don't sign: "knows a guy who knows a guy" types, recent graduates with no network, anyone asking for a base salary (that's an employee, not a reseller).

The affiliate program

Public URL: omnix.co.ke/affiliate !' sign up !' get link !' 33% commission on first purchase only (no compounding on renewals).

After every successful install, ask:

"You know 3 other pharmacies in Nairobi, right? Here's your affiliate link — you earn KES 10,000 back for every one who installs. Just share this WhatsApp."

Turn every customer into an affiliate. This is where compounding starts.

Managing your money

Bank setup — Week 1

1. **Business M-Pesa Till** — customer payments land here
2. **Business bank** — sweep from Till weekly (M-Pesa fees 1% vs bank 0.3%)
3. **Personal bank** — separate from business (KRA cares)
4. **Emergency runway** — 3 months locked, untouchable

The 60/20/10/10 split

Every KES in gets split immediately:

%	Bucket	Purpose
60%	Take-home	Rent, food, transport, family
20%	Business runway	Petrol, printer paper, tools, subs
10%	Tax reserve	Save monthly, file annually
10%	Emergency runway	Build to 3 months of expenses

Never dip into tax reserve or emergency for feature development. If you need to hire, that's business runway or new revenue.

KRA — the boring critical stuff

- Register your business with KRA (KES 30k+/month !' income tax matters)
- File monthly VAT return

(Omnix exports the data)

- File monthly PAYE if you hire (even part-time)
- KES 200k+/month revenue !' register for VAT (mandatory)

You'll thank yourself in month 12 when you're audited. Every founder eventually is.

Part 3 — Product decisions you'll face

The frameworks for the questions that will hit you 3× a week.

"Can you add feature X?"

1. Did this customer already pay for the module they want changed? No ! "That's part of a bigger paid feature I'm planning; can I add you to the waitlist?"
2. 1-hour change or 1-week? 1-week !' same as above.
3. Have 3+ paying customers asked? Yes !' prioritize.
4. Would I build this for myself if I ran their business? Yes !' probably worth it.

Say no to 80% of feature requests in Month 1. Patterns emerge by Month 3.

"Your competitor has feature Y"

- Is Y offline-capable? Most SaaS POS aren't. If they need offline, they need you.
- Is Y KRA-compliant? Most cheap competitors aren't. If they need KRA, they need you.
- Is Y free or paid? If competitor charges monthly, you win on 3-year TCO.

If they still won't buy: they were never your customer. Move to the next.

"Should I add a new module?"

Not this year. Four modules is enough. Each needs 10+ paying customers before it stabilizes. Adding module #5 while 1-4 are at 5-15 each dilutes everything.

Only add if a specific customer pays a KES 200,000+ development fee to fund it. Then you have a real business case.

"Should I hire?"

Never before 20 paying customers. Then:

- **First hire (month 3-5):** part-time installer + support person, KES 30-40k/month, works 3 days a week
- **Second hire (month 6-9):** full-time customer success, handles onboarding + upsell
- **Third hire (year 2):** another developer, only if you literally cannot ship fixes fast enough

Hire slowly. Firing is much harder in Kenya than in the US — labor law protects the employee heavily. Every hire should be someone you'd give a second chance to twice.

Red flags — call me immediately

- Auto-updater fails on 3+ customer machines in a week
- A customer's data becomes unrecoverable
- KRA eTIMS submission fails on live invoices
- A reseller starts undercutting your price
- A customer publicly complains — address same-day
- **You skip 3 days of outreach in a row** — this is the beginning of failure mode, force yourself back

When you know you're winning

- **Week 2:** first paying customer texts "the app is working, thank you"
- **Month 1:** 15+ paying customers, KES 200k in your account, reseller closed 3 installs
- **Month 3:** 50+ customers, first affiliate compound (referral of referral), take-home KES 300k/month
- **Month 6:** 150 customers, can afford first hire, take 1 day off/week guilt-free
- **Month 12:** 500 customers, ARR KES 6M/year, you're a real CEO

When to escalate to your CTO (me)

Fastest path to a fix. Drop me a message with (a) exact error text, (b) what you were doing, (c) which module.

- "Crashes on X page with error Y"
- "Customer reports Z is broken"
- "How do I do X"
- "Dashboard/report shows wrong numbers"

I ship same-day for anything touching a paying customer's day.

When NOT to escalate

- "Should I add feature X" — decide yourself, framework above
 - "How do I price this" — KES 30k/15k launch, don't negotiate down
 - "Design suggestion for landing page" — nice-to-have, not blocking sales
 - "Marketing copy for social" — you write faster than I do
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Part 4 — The unspoken rules

The stuff nobody puts in playbooks.

Rule 1 — protect your energy like it's revenue

An hour of your best energy is worth 4 hours of your tired energy. Guard the morning 06:00-11:00 aggressively. This is when you do sales. Meetings, admin, low-priority WhatsApp — after lunch. Don't reverse this.

Rule 2 — dress for the customer, not yourself

Kenyan shop owners take you more seriously in trousers + a shirt than jeans + a hoodie. Not always. In Nairobi CBD, absolutely. Buy 3 nice shirts + 2 pairs of trousers if you don't already have them. Consider it business runway. It closes sales.

Rule 3 — the calendar is honest, feelings aren't

If you're spending 40 hours a week on features and 5 on sales, you're a developer, not a CEO. Look at your Atlas Pipelines + calendar weekly. The ratio should be inverted. Adjust before Friday.

Rule 4 — every customer is a case study

When you install for a customer, mentally log:

- What did they say the problem was?
- What did they say when they saw the demo?
- What was their exact objection?
- What made them say yes?
- Would they refer me?

Write these in Atlas notes. By customer #10 you'll see 3 patterns. Those patterns are your marketing.

Rule 5 — never lie in a demo

Ever. Not about features. Not about customers. Not about price. Not about "how many people we have." Kenya is small. Word travels fast. Lie once and you're dead in the community.

If a feature doesn't exist yet: "That's on the roadmap. Not in this release. Here's what does work today."

If you have zero customers yet: "We're in launch — first 10 pharmacies get 50% off." Truth. Sells better than a lie.

If a competitor is better at something specific: "Yeah, Loyverse is good at X. I'm better at Y — which matters more for your business?"

Rule 6 — you're paid to say things nobody else will

- A reseller performing badly? Have the awkward conversation. Don't wait.
- A customer using the product wrong? Correct them politely. Better now than at month 6.
- A partnership offer that smells off? Say no fast, don't string them along.
- A hire under-performing at month 2? End it cleanly. Don't drag it to month 6.

The comfort of avoidance costs you weeks. The discomfort of honesty costs you 10 minutes. Choose 10 minutes.

Rule 7 — the day you feel like an impostor is the day you're closest to becoming one

Impostor syndrome hits hardest right before breakthrough. When you think "who am I to charge KES 30,000 for this?" — that's when you're one week away from your third paid customer. Do not stop.

If you don't feel like an impostor at least twice a month for the first year, you're not stretching. Welcome the feeling. It means you're growing.

Rule 8 — the mission is bigger than you

Omnix is not "Justine's app." Omnix is the software that finally makes Kenyan SME owners as productive as their global peers. That mission survives you. It doesn't need your ego. It needs your discipline.

When you doubt yourself, remember: the pharmacy owner in Kilifi with 400 SKUs and no idea what she made yesterday is the reason. She doesn't need you to be brave. She needs the app to work, the price to be fair, and someone she can call when it breaks. That's it. Deliver that.

The final rule

A day without an outreach message sent is a wasted day. No exceptions. Weekends have their own routine (Saturday morning).

If Monday ends and you sent zero messages, you didn't run a business that day. Send them Tuesday morning before anything else. Do not open your code editor before those 20 messages have gone out.

That's it. This is the operating manual. Print it if that helps. The rest is execution.

Send the messages.

